

Home > Travel > Jeju Island



Jeju Island Travel Guide 2026

Korea's volcanic island paradise — crater lakes, lava tubes, tangerine farms, black-sand beaches, and a culture distinct from the mainland.

700K

Population

1h

From Seoul (flight)

UNESCO

World Heritage Site

1,950m

Hallasan height



Top Attractions



Hallasan National Park

Korea's highest peak (1,950m) — a dormant volcano with a crater lake at the summit. Multiple hiking trails from 3 to 9 hours.



Manjanggul Lava Tube

One of the world's longest lava tubes — a 13km underground cave system formed by ancient volcanic activity. UNESCO listed.



Hyeopjae Beach



Seongsan Ilchulbong

Pristine white sand and turquoise water — Jeju's most beautiful beach, backed by a pine forest and a lava rock shoreline.

"Sunrise Peak" — a dramatic volcanic tuff cone rising from the sea. The sunrise view from the top is one of Korea's most iconic sights.



Tangerine Farms (감귤밭)

Jeju is famous for its sweet tangerines — visit a farm in autumn (Oct–Dec) to pick and eat them straight from the tree.



Jungmun Resort Area

Jeju's upscale resort strip — luxury hotels, Cheonjeyeon Waterfall, Yeomiji Botanical Garden and the famous Jusangjeolli lava cliffs.

Jeju by Area

Jeju Island is roughly divided into east, west, north and south — plan your days by area to avoid excessive driving.

Jeju City (North)

- Yongduam Rock (Dragon Head Rock)
- Jeju Folk Village Museum
- Dongmun Traditional Market
- Jeju Airport — main entry point

East Jeju

- Seongsan Ilchulbong (Sunrise Peak)
- Manjanggul Lava Tube
- Seopjikoji Coastal Road
- Haenyeo (female diver) shows

West Jeju

- Hyeopjae Beach & Hallim Park
- Olle Trail sections (7 & 14)
- Biyangdo Island day trip
- Aewol Handam Coastal Road

South Jeju

- Jungmun Resort & waterfall
- Jusangjeolli Lava Cliffs
- Hallasan hiking (Eorimok trail)
- Seogwipo City seafood market

Jeju Food Specialties



Heuk Dwaegi (흑돼지)



Haenyeo Seafood (해녀 음식)



Hallabong (한라봉)

Jeju's black pork — richer flavor than regular pork. Grilled at the table and eaten with island-grown vegetables.

Dishes made from ingredients harvested by Jeju's famous female divers — abalone, sea urchin, conch.

Jeju's prized citrus fruit — sweeter than a regular tangerine, knobby on top. Available Nov–Feb.



Jeju Sool (제주술)

Jeju craft beer and soju made from local ingredients — try at the many Jeju-themed breweries.



Ome (오메기떡)

Traditional Jeju rice cake made from foxtail millet — chewy, nutty, a beloved local snack.



Galchi Jorim (갈치조림)

Braised hairtail fish — a Jeju specialty slow-cooked in spicy soy sauce with vegetables.

Getting to Jeju



Flight — Only Realistic Option

There's no train or bridge to Jeju. Flights from Gimpo (Seoul) take ~1 hour. Flights from Incheon take ~1h 10min. Check Korean Air, Asiana, Jeju Air, T'way, Jin Air for cheap fares. Book early — Jeju route is one of the world's busiest.



Ferry (Slow but Scenic)

Mokpo → Jeju: ~5 hours by high-speed ferry. Wando → Jeju: ~2.5 hours. Popular with cyclists and those bringing cars. Book via **Korean Ferry** app.

Getting Around Jeju

TRANSPORT OPTIONS

- **Rental Car — Best option:** Jeju's public transport is limited. Renting a car gives full freedom. International driving permit required. Book in advance.
- **Scooter/E-bike rental:** Good for coastal roads and Olle Trails. Available in Jeju City and Seogwipo.
- **Bus:** Intercity buses connect major attractions but are infrequent (1–2 per hour). Use Naver Maps for routes.
- **Taxi:** Available and reasonably priced. Jeju taxis are metered — no scams.



Best Time to Visit Jeju

BY SEASON

- **Spring (Mar–May)** — Canola flower fields turn yellow (February peak), cherry blossoms, mild weather
- **Summer (Jun–Aug)** — Beach season, hot and humid, rainy season in late June–July
- **Autumn (Sep–Nov)** — Best hiking weather, tangerine harvest begins in October, stunning foliage
- **Winter (Dec–Feb)** — Fewest tourists, cheapest prices, Hallasan may have snow, Hallabong citrus season

💡 Jeju Travel Tips:

- Jeju is visa-free for most nationalities (even if you need a visa for mainland Korea) — check this before planning.
- Download **Naver Maps** and **Kakao Maps** — both work better than Google Maps on the island.
- Book accommodation in advance during May (canola season) and October (autumn) — it fills up fast.

Useful Phrases in Jeju

한라산 등산 코스 뭐가 좋아요? *hal-la-san deung-san ko-seu mwo-ga jo-a-yo?* Which Hallasan trail is good?

흑돼지 어디서 먹어요? *heuk-dwae-ji eo-di-seo meo-geo-yo?* Where can I eat black pork?

렌터카 빌리고 싶은데요. *ren-teo-ka bil-li-go si-peun-de-yo.* I'd like to rent a car.

제주 특산물 뭐예요? *je-ju teuk-san-pum mwo-ye-yo?* What are Jeju's specialties?

Planning your Jeju trip?

Know the Korean you need before you arrive — 41 chapters, from zero to confident speaker.

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Travel Conversations →

